I began Chapter 3 with a description of the great statue of the poet-sage Thiruvalluvar which stands on the larger of the two islets offshore at Kanyakumari. But the other, smaller islet also has its memorial: a small temple built to commemorate the Bengali aristocrat Narendranath Datta, better known as Swami Vivekananda. It was here on this rock that the young revivalist sat and meditated for three days in December 1892 before hitting upon what he believed to be the solution for resolving India's ills. This was not, as is so widely believed today, a plan to unite India politically, but a project he termed 'our Work' that would unite Indian spirituality with Western liberty and practicality.[9]

'At Cape Comorin, sitting in Mother Kumari's temple, sitting on the last bit of Indian rock, I hit upon a plan,' was how Vivekananda described his thinking to a fellow swami.